WIKIPEDIA 25
25 years of the free encyclopedia

Dungeon Crawler Carl

Dungeon Crawler Carl is a science fantasy LitRPG book series written by American author Matt Dinniman. Initially self published by Dinniman via online publisher *Royal Road*, it and its seven sequels were acquired by Ace Books in 2024.[1]

The series follows Carl and his ex-girlfriend's cat, Princess Donut, two of the few survivors of the mining, transporting, processing, and consumption of Earth's resources by an alien corporation, as they are forced to compete in a dungeon crawl recreated from those resources for an intergalactic reality show program. As of December 2025, the first eight books have sold over ten million copies. The eighth book was released in May 2026, with plans to complete the series with two more books. Additionally, a television adaptation has been greenlit for production by Peacock, and there are further plans for graphic novels, audio programs, a card game, and a tabletop role-playing game.

Premise

Carl, a United States Coast Guard veteran, and Princess Donut, his ex-girlfriend's cat, are part of a few million beings that escape the elimination of the human species and mining of Earth's resources by the alien Borant Corporation. To survive, they are forced to enter the World Dungeon, an eighteen-level dungeon crawl borrowing ideas from tabletop role-playing and video games, reconstructed from Earth's resources. The efforts to survive of Carl and other survivors, all known as crawlers, are live-streamed across the universe as a game show called *Dungeon*

Dungeon Crawler Carl



Cover used for the ebook, audiobook, and self-published version of the first entry, featuring Carl (right) and Donut (bottom left)

Author	Matt Dinniman
Cover artist	Luciano Fleitas
Country	United States
Language	English
Genre	LitRPG, Science fantasy
Publisher	Ace Books
Media type	Print (hardcover and paperback),

audiobook, e-book

Crawler World, a process that has been used for several seasons by various corporations to fund the mining operations of other planets.[2] Among the gear Carl earns for entering the dungeon is an enchanted pet biscuit. Donut eats it and becomes sapient, able to talk and use magic.

Carl and Donut meet several other crawlers, non-player characters, and aliens, some of whom become their allies. On their journey, the crawlers must select their character race and class and fight mobs and bosses, gaining new gear, earning experience, and improving their attributes to become stronger for surviving deeper levels of the dungeon. The dungeon itself is run by an increasingly-erratic "System AI" that provides crawlers with information, sets difficulties, and distributes loot. On each level, crawlers have a limited amount of time to reach the stairs to the next dungeon level or are killed when the current level collapses. As part of *Dungeon Crawler World*, they must also seek popularity with the audience to gain sponsors and get better gear, critical for survival. Carl also learns from his interactions with alien allies that Borant is under pressure to complete *Dungeon Crawler World* as quickly as possible to stay solvent and avoid a hostile takeover from other entities that make up a galaxy-spanning Syndicate, leading to less time and more dangerous situations that Carl and Donut must face. Carl becomes resolved to fight back against Borant and the Syndicate despite the challenges the dungeon puts forth, assuring himself that they will not break him.

Characters

- Carl, a Coast Guard veteran who enters the World Dungeon without shoes or pants, along with his ex-girlfriend's cat, Donut.
- Princess Donut, Carl's ex-girlfriend's Persian cat, a former cat show champion who develops the ability to talk shortly after the game begins.
- The System AI, the artificial intelligence which is running and administering the current edition of the crawl.
- Mordecai, a former crawler nearing the end of his tenure, serving as Carl and Donut's tutorial guide, and later as Donut's manager.
- Members of Team Meadow Lark, employees and residents of a nursing home who Carl befriends. This includes nurses Imani and Yolanda, handymen and brothers Brandon and Chris, and elderly resident Elle.
- Katia, an Icelandic professor who joins Carl and Donut's party.
- Mongo, a velociraptor that Donut gains as a pet.
- Samantha, a demi-goddess trapped in the head of a sex doll.
- Miriam Dom, an Italian goat shepherd, and Prepotente, a goat from her flock who was transformed into a humanoid, sapient goat at the start of the dungeon.
- Zev, a fish-like alien who works for Borant as a dungeon admin and serves as Carl and Donut's public relations manager.

- Odette, a former crawler and host of one of the more popular talk shows associated with the dungeon who discreetly helps Carl.
- Lucia Mar, a young crawler of around 13 years with an apparent split personality. She is accompanied by her two Rottweiler dogs.
- Florin, a former mercenary soldier crawler who chooses a crocodile-like race.
- Firas and Louis, two laid-back crawlers Carl meets on the fifth floor, whom Carl helps to groom into competent crawlers.
- Juice Box, a changeling NPC who spearheads an NPC revolt.

Development



Matt Dinniman at the 2025 AuthorCon in Williamsburg, Virginia, holding a plush of Princess Donut

Prior to writing the series, Matt Dinniman had made his living going to cat shows and drawing illustrations of cats for their owners. During his breaks, he began writing short segments of the story via the digital platform *Royal Road* in 2019, where it quickly gained popularity. When the COVID-19 pandemic hit in 2020, most of the cat shows were cancelled, and Dinniman switched to writing the series full-time, as well as using Amazon for self-publishing. [3]

While writing the series, Dinniman drew upon his experience playing MMOs such as *RuneScape*, as well as the concept of in-game chatting, which he noted "adds another element because there's all these different dynamics happening at once."[4] Prior to writing the series, Dinniman developed a desire to write a novel with a death-game setting; he also wanted to include a tortoiseshell-colored Persian cat after seeing one at a cat show where he was working as an artist. Dinniman has said he did not initially plan for the cat to be sapient, and that this developed as he continued writing the series, as he tends to create and embellish the story as he goes. This eventually led to the creation of Princess Donut as she is presented in the series, a character that Dinniman has stated is vital to the series. Dinniman is known for his interaction with his fanbase and allows his Patreon subscribers to impact some limited elements of the story by voting on the outcome of external factors, such as loot box content,[5] or to have much of *The Eye of the Bedlam Bride* taking place in Cuba.[6]

The series includes dark and comedic elements. In an interview with *Grimdark Magazine,* Dinniman stated that it was difficult to maintain the balance between these two elements and that rather than automatically write a comedic scene after each dark one, he instead relies "on the characters themselves to get from point A to B, and humor is oftentimes a major coping

mechanism."[7] Dinniman initially kept track of the series' characters and storylines via a spreadsheet that grew up to 198 pages, requiring the use of a second spreadsheet to track the content on the first. The size of the spreadsheet eventually crashed Dinniman's computer, causing the author to hire someone to create a Notion database for better ease of use.[5] While working on the manuscript for *A Parade of Horribles* Dinniman reported that he wrote for about eight to twelve hours a day, which he spent in his home as well as at bars and coffee shops.[8]

In 2024, Dinniman stated that he planned for the series to span ten books, but that "nothing is set in stone".[9] Dinniman confirmed his plans to end the series with the ninth book, split across two works, in a February 2026 interview.[10]

Publication history

Initial publication and Ace Books

Dinniman began publishing *Dungeon Crawler Carl* on *Royal Road* in 2020. He self-published the first book in the series on Amazon on October 2, 2020, in ebook and paperback format.[11][4] He would continue in this form until 2024, when print rights to the series were picked up by Penguin Random House, which released the first volume through the Ace Books publishing wing in mid-2024, while Dinniman was able to retain the digital publication rights.[8] Ebook rights to the series are still held by Dinniman, who continues to self-publish digitally through Amazon.[7] As of May 2026, eight novels in the series have been published, most self-published before the series was picked up by Ace Books.[2]

In response to questions about whether the publisher would make changes to the series, Dinniman responded that the story would remain the same but that the series had undergone rigorous edits, and that the releases would contain parts of a bonus in-universe novella, *Backstage at the Pineapple Cabaret*.[7]

Audiobooks

The main audiobook adaptations of the *Dungeon Crawler Carl* series have been narrated by Jeff Hays, who has produced the adaptations via his company Soundbooth Theater.[12] Dinniman has stated that Hays's narration of female characters is so convincing that he has had people ask him if Annie Ellicott, a Soundbooth Theater artist, was an uncredited narrator for the first book.[5] Some guest narrators have appeared on the audiobooks, such as Travis Baldree and Patrick Warburton in book six.[13]

Per Dinniman, sales of the audiobook adaptations of the novels have surpassed the physical and e-book copies of the series, and much of his fanbase first experienced the series via Audible.[5]

In addition to the main audiobook version, the series has a separate production called an "Audio Immersion Tunnel", with a full-cast, original sound effects and music.[7] According to the author, these will not replace the existing audiobooks and are a separate product.

Series entries

No.	Title	Release date	Dungeon Floor	Pages	Audio length	ISBN
1	*Dungeon Crawler Carl*	September 21, 2020 (Paperback) October 2, 2020 (Kindle)	1 & 2	444[14]	13 hrs 31 mins[15]	979-8688591507
Carl and Donut enter the dungeon and meet Mordecai, who teaches them the rules of the dungeon and their best path to survive. Carl and Donut face several bosses during the first two floors, during which Donut gains Mongo as a pet. Carl learns that he and Donut are among the most popular crawlers on *Dungeon Crawler World*, gaining interview appearances with Odette, along with meeting Zev. On another interview show, Carl insults Maestro, a younger member of the royal family of the orc-based Skull Empire, who vows revenge on Carl. Donut gains a magic tiara, the Enchanted Crown of the Sepsis Whore, which gives her additional powers but requires her to kill all royal members of the Blood Sultanate by the ninth floor in order to descend further.						
2	*Carl's Doomsday Scenario*	January 2, 2021	3	362[16]	11 hrs 28 mins[15]	979-8588333764
On the third floor, the surviving crawlers select their race and class. Carl selects the Compensated Anarchist class, while Donut opts for the Former Child Actor class, which allows Mordecai to become her manager and provide them with more information and assistance on the dungeon. They find themselves in a more open-world scenario with cities surrounded by wasteland. Despite Mordecai's caution against accepting quests, Carl gets sucked into a third-party quest line. During a roundtable program, he meets another top crawler, Hekla, who asks Carl to help one of her party, Katia, now a shapeshifter and located near Carl, to level up. Carl agrees, but narrowly escapes an assassination attempt by Maestro during the program. In completing another quest, Carl nearly damages a powerful soul crystal threatening to kill crawlers for miles around, but captures it in a magic container moments before it explodes, becoming the titular "Carl's Doomsday Scenario" item in his inventory.						
3	*The Dungeon Anarchist's Cookbook*	March 19, 2021	4	532[17]	16 hrs 54 mins[15]	979-8724495066
On the fourth floor, the surviving crawlers fight through the "Iron Tangle", a complex maze of underground trains and subways. The crawlers also get their first sponsors' loot box; Carl's box gives him a choice of prizes, and he selects what appears to be a simple cookbook. Due to his class, he can read special information about the dungeon written into it by previous crawlers. The various groups find they must collaborate on their knowledge of the Tangle to find and clear a path to the stairs. Carl, Donut, and Katia join up with Hekla's group to clear out one of the tunnels. When Donut reveals that Hekla was trying to kill Katia, Katia indirectly kills Hekla and retrieves her magical crossbow, which was the source of Hekla's power, and her second-in-command and Katia's former friend, Eva, vows revenge. As the Tangle falls into chaos near the end of the level with many crawlers trapped a distance from any stairs, Carl risks summoning the god sponsored by Maestro to kill the level's major boss and open the path to the fifth floor.						
4	*The Gate of the Feral Gods*	June 14, 2021	5	584[18]	18 hrs 3 mins[15]	979-8520410171

The remaining crawlers are distributed among bubble worlds, each requiring four bosses to be killed to "pop" the bubble and access the stairs. Carl, Donut, and Katia find that their bubble includes the parts for the Gate of the Feral Gods, an artifact that can open portals to any location, including other floors, but which summons a feral god at the entrance portal. During one of their interviews, Carl discreetly causes the death of a dungeon admin and learns that several other admins have been killed already this season. Carl's group acquires Samantha, a demi-goddess trapped in the head of a sex doll, during the process of clearing their bubble. After successfully opening their bubble, Carl's group works with others using the Gate to help them escape to the next floor. Before leaving, Carl's group uses the Gate one last time to flood out a good portion of the main city on the ninth floor where Faction Wars will occur, which will make it harder for alien hunters to kill them once they reach it.						
5	*The Butcher's Masquerade*	February 19, 2022	6 & 7	730[19]	23 hrs 33 mins[15]	979-8418566102
The sixth floor, the Hunting Grounds, allows over a thousand alien hunters to enter the dungeon and kill crawlers for rewards, though they are themselves fair game for the crawlers. Carl is forced to give up the Gate until later in the dungeon, but with Quasar's help, is able to coerce special benefits, including a spell that will send allied NPCs to the ninth floor to prepare for Faction Wars. As Carl and the other crawlers methodically work to take out the hunters, they prepare for a giant ball, the Butcher's Masquerade, to be held for the top crawlers just before the level collapses. Carl suspects it to be a trap to kill them off, and with his friends defeats a major boss at the end of the ball, though many of the crawlers die in battle. With the help of Donut's fan club outside the dungeon, Carl is able to secure a place in the Faction Wars, and sends several NPCs ahead to the ninth floor to prepare. Katia, in searching for Eva, stumbles on her body too late before Eva slaps the Crown of the Septis Whore on Katia as she dies, which will limit either Donut or Katia from progressing past the ninth floor. On entering the seventh floor, Prepotente deduces the nature of the floor from earlier clues and sponsor items received by Donut, and uses this to shortcut the floor, taking all survivors to the eighth floor prematurely.						
6	*The Eye of the Bedlam Bride*	June 14, 2023	8	692[20]	26 hrs 46 mins[15]	979-8396866379
On the eighth floor, the remaining crawlers must battle using a Pokémon style card game, collecting totems to fight for them. At Samantha's insistence, they recruit Shi Maria, a giant spider-like creature also known as the Bedlam Bride, who claims she can help Samantha acquire a body. In the floor's second phase, each squad must acquire a key from a boss to unlock an exit, but the system AI, out of control of the admins and having placed a quarantine around the Earth solar system, breaks the rules and uses people from the crawlers' past to create these bosses, and several squads fail to get a key. Carl realizes the floor was designed to force squads to battle over keys and to significantly trim the remaining crawlers. Carl inadvertently causes a demon eviction event during the final phase, summoning numerous demons to the floor. Carl, using hints from the cookbook, designs a method to rescue all the surviving crawlers without keys, thus improving their chances in Faction Wars. While his plan works, Shi Maria invades Carl's body during combat and forces him to tattoo the Eye of the Bedlam Bride on his chest, assuring her mind will remain with him as he descends deeper.						
7	*This Inevitable Ruin*	November 7, 2024	9	722[21]	28 hrs 40 mins[15]	979-8344591230
The ninth floor features Faction Wars, where nine teams of mercenaries led by alien warlords attempt to defeat the others, normally conscripting any crawlers that reach the flood to be used as fodder. However, through Carl and Donut's actions, they have arranged to become the ninth faction and are able to bring most surviving crawlers onto their team, and align themselves with Juicebox and her team of NPCs brought from previous floors; he is also joined by thousands of former crawlers that have come to Earth to help fight against the Syndicate, led by previous writers of the Cookbook. Carl also was able to secure a rule change that leaves all the warlords vulnerable on this floor. Carl helps Katia kill the remaining Blood Sultanate members while systematically defeating the other warlords, leaving only the crawlers and the NPC teams left. They use a spell Carl exchanged for the Gate of the Feral Gods to transport the NPCs to the twelfth floor to prepare for the Ascendency, and Katia ingests a flower received as a sponsored box that grants her a gift from a goddess, to become pregnant and be forced out of the dungeon and sent to the kinder care facility on Earth's surface where the surviving children of Earth are being cared for, allowing Donut to be able to descend with Carl.						

8	*A Parade of Horribles*	May 12, 2026	10 & 11	624[22]	20h 26min[15]	979-8217190065

On the tenth floor, the surviving crawlers compete across seven escalating vehicle races with audience-voted upgrades between heats. Using information from Akuma, the War Mage leader from Faction Wars, Carl arranges for over two hundred crawlers and allies to escape the playing field into a space called the Pineapple Cabaret. Twenty-three crawlers descend to the eleventh floor.

The eleventh floor opens with the Parade of Horribles, a procession past thousands of silent masked figures representing the accumulated consciousness of dead dungeon mobs and NPCs, ending in a boss arena. Carl executes a plan concealed from his allies, manipulating the gods Taranis and Emberus into fighting each other while simultaneously confronting Scolopendra, the level-500 dungeon final boss. Donut accidentally uses the wrong transformation biscuit on the defeated Scolopendra, turning the dungeon boss into a sapient crawler party member rather than a controllable pet. Nineteen crawlers proceed to the twelfth floor as the Ascendency battles begin, and Carl's former deity markings are replaced by a Mark of the Damned.

Second publication

Starting in August 2024, Ace Books took over publishing the paperback and hardback versions of the books. Each book contains a passage of the multi-part novella *Backstage at the Pineapple Cabaret*.[23]

No.	Title	Release Date	Pages	ISBN
1	*Dungeon Crawler Carl*	August 27, 2024	464	9780593820247
2	*Carl's Doomsday Scenario*	September 24, 2024	384	9780593820261
3	*The Dungeon Anarchist's Cookbook*	March 11, 2025	544	9780593820285
4	*The Gate of the Feral Gods*	March 11, 2025	608	9780593955970
5	*The Butcher's Masquerade*	April 8, 2025	720	9780593955994
6	*The Eye of the Bedlam Bride*	May 13, 2025	832	9780593956014
7	*This Inevitable Ruin*	September 23, 2025	880	9798217190041
8	*A Parade of Horribles*	May 12, 2026	704	9798217190065

Reception

Reviews and accolades

In a review of the first book for *Locus*, Gabino Iglesias criticized some jokes and said he found the book repetitive, but wrote that "the important thing here is that the novel never becomes boring" and that the "shortcomings are easy to overlook".[2] Tonya Cherry of CKRM favorably reviewed the series, praising the audiobook narration and calling the series "a wild ride that blends humor, action, and a touch of heart, making for an unforgettable journey."[24]

The first book was nominated for the 2026 Arthur C. Clarke Award.[25]

Sales

As of December 2024, the first four books published by Ace had sold almost 55,000 copies.[26] In March 2025 the seventh book in the series, *This Inevitable Ruin*, ranked #2 on *The New York Times*' Best Seller List for Audio Fiction,[27] while the fourth book, *The Gate of the Feral Gods*, ranked #9 on the Best Seller List for Hardcover Fiction.[28] In 2025 the bookstore chain Books-A-Million named the first entry in the series as its inaugural Book of the Year, which is to recognize a title that "best embodies the joy of reading and the enthusiasm of BAM's team".[29] By June 2026, the first eight books had sold more than 10 million copies.[30] The first book had sold more than 2.7 million by May 2026, and had been on the *The New York Times* Best Seller list for 19 straight weeks.[31]



Dungeon Crawler Carl and Princess Donut cosplayers at Raven Con 2026 in Richmond, Virginia

Legacy

The Colorado Avalanche held a *Dungeon Crawler Carl* night on April 11, 2026, prompted by the Avalanche's Scott Wedgewood, who had become a fan of the series during COVID. Dinniman was in attendance, and the event was used to support a local animal rescue in honor of the Princess Donut character.[32]

Dungeon Crawler Carl helped to popularize the LitRPG genre outside of its roots in southeast Asian culture.[33][31] In a 2026 review, Laura Miller of *Slate* praised the *Dungeon Crawler Carl* series as a leading example in the LitRPG genre, noting the surprising emotional and political depth the gaming format was capable of when utilized as a metaphor. She wrote, "the crawlers' exploitation at the hands of a heartless entertainment industry, and the corporate skullduggery behind the scenes, become an increasingly rich and pointed analogy to the power imbalances of our own world."[34]

Adaptations

Television adaptation

In August 2024, it was announced that Universal International Studios, in collaboration with Seth MacFarlane's Fuzzy Door Productions, acquired the rights to adapt *Dungeon Crawler Carl* into a television series. Christopher Yost is set to write the series adaptation. Dinniman expressed excitement about the adaptation, while Erica Huggins, President of Fuzzy Door, described the project as aligning with the company's vision for genre-bending storytelling.[35] By February 2026, Dinniman said that Yost had completed a few episodes, a streaming service had acquired the broadcast rights, and they were nearing the point where they would need to establish whether it would be live-action or animated, and set up contracts for production.[10]

The show was confirmed to be a live-action adaption for the Peacock service with development starting in April 2026. Dinniman, an executive producer for the show, said that he trusts MacFarlane's Fuzzy Door to make CGI elements, as expected for Princess Donut, to look good in live action given how shows like *The Orville* and *Ted* have come out.[36] Peacock greenlit the series, rather than just a pilot episode, to start production in June 2026.[30]

Webcomic

In 2025 Dinniman announced that a webcomic adaptation of *Dungeon Crawler Carl* was in development and would be published through Webtoon. The project was done in partnership with Aethon Books' Webcomic Branch and Laurel Pursuit. The first episode was published on July 17, 2025.[37] The episode was later distributed in physical format as part of Free Comic Book Day 2026.[38] The webcomic is currently published in print format through Vault Comics, the first volume of which was published in May 2026.[39][40]

Graphic novel

Dungeon Crawler Carl: Crocodile is an upcoming graphic novel set in the *Dungeon Crawler Carl* universe that will be published by Vault Comics. Plans for the book, which will be part of the series canon, were announced in August 2025; the following month, Vault Comics revealed that the graphic novel would follow the Crocodilian mercenary Florin DuPont and would be named *Dungeon Crawler Carl: Crocodile*.[41] Michael Moreci and Brett Bean have been selected to work on the graphic novel's story and artwork.[42] Funding for the graphic novel will be raised via a crowdfunding campaign.[43]

Games

On July 29, 2025, Renegade Game Studios announced that they had partnered with Dinniman to develop a tabletop role-playing game set in the *Dungeon Crawler Carl* universe. The game is scheduled to release in 2026. Renegade also announced plans to develop board games and deck-building games for the series in the future.[44][45] Renegade launched a BackerKit crowdfunding campaign for both the tabletop RPG and *Unstoppable*, a deck-building game using a ruleset similar to *Mystic Vale*, on April 14, 2026, with over $4.5 million raised on its first day,[46][47] and nearing $10 million before it closed.[33]

Merchandise

Playmates Toys is producing several lines of toys, figurines, trading cards, and other goods based on the series, set for initial release around July 2026.[48]

See also

- *Operation Bounce House*, a 2026 science fiction novel by Dinniman

References

1. Nguyen, Vivian (October 14, 2024). "LitRPG Goes Mainstream" (https://www.proquest.com/docview/3115836594). *Publishers Weekly*. **271** (39): 41. ProQuest 3115836594 (https://www.proquest.com/docview/3115836594).
2. Iglesias, Gabino (January 10, 2025). "Dungeon Crawler Carl by Matt Dinniman: Review by Gabino Iglesias" (https://locusmag.com/2025/01/dungeon-crawler-carl-by-matt-dinniman-review-by-gabino-iglesias/). *Locus Online*. Retrieved January 26, 2025.
3. Miller, Laura (February 7, 2026). "The Unlikely Hit That's Popularizing a Whole New Type of Novel" (https://slate.com/culture/2026/02/dungeon-crawler-carl-book-series-litrpg-audiobook-matt-dinniman.html). *Slate*. ISSN 1091-2339 (https://search.worldcat.org/issn/1091-2339). Retrieved February 14, 2026.
4. "Online and role-playing games inspired WA author's fantasy series" (https://www.seattletimes.com/entertainment/books/wa-author-matt-dinniman-on-popular-dungeon-crawler-carl-series/). *The Seattle Times*. March 7, 2025. Retrieved March 31, 2025.
5. "Dungeon Crawler Carl creator Matt Dinniman says LitRPG is just getting started" (https://www.audible.com/blog/matt-dinniman-dungeon-crawler-carl-audio-interview). *Audible Blog*. Retrieved March 31, 2025.
6. https://www.goodreads.com/interviews/show/1601
7. Tabler, Elizabeth (September 6, 2024). "An Interview with Matt Dinniman" (https://www.grimdarkmagazine.com/an-interview-with-matt-dinniman/). *Grimdark Magazine*. Retrieved March 31, 2025.
8. Alter, Alexandra (December 12, 2025). "Gonzo Fans Have Made 'Dungeon Crawler Carl' Into a Global Blockbuster" (https://www.nytimes.com/2025/12/12/books/review/dungeon-crawler-carl-

matt-dinniman.html). *The New York Times*.
9. Phipps, C. T. (August 4, 2023). "Interview - Matt Dinniman, Author of Dungeon Crawler Carl" (https://beforewegoblog.com/interview-matt-dinniman-author-of-dungeon-crawler-carl/). *BEFOREWEGOBLOG*. Retrieved March 31, 2025.
10. Maas, Jennifer (February 28, 2026). " 'Dungeon Crawler Carl' Author Matt Dinniman Talks Live-Action TV Series Plans, Book 8 Plot and 'Operation Bounce House' " (https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/dungeon-crawler-carl-tv-show-book-8-operation-bounce-house-1236674799/). *Variety*. Retrieved February 28, 2026.
11. Dinniman, Matt (2020). *Dungeon Crawler Carl Book 1*. Dandy House. ISBN 979-8-6885-9150-7.
12. "Sound Off: What's New in the Audio Market" (https://www.proquest.com/docview/3062954100). *Publishers Weekly*. **271** (22): 44–80. June 3, 2024. ProQuest 3062954100 (https://www.proquest.com/docview/3062954100).
13. "Dungeon Crawler Carl, Book 6: The Eye of the Bedlam Bride" (https://soundbooththeater.com/shop/audiobooks/dungeon-crawler-carl-book-6-the-eye-of-the-bedlam-bride/). *Soundbooth Theater*. Retrieved December 18, 2024.
14. "*Dungeon Crawler Carl*" (https://bookscouter.com/book/9798688591507-dungeon-crawler-carl-a-litrpg-gamelit-adventure). *BookScouter*. Retrieved November 16, 2023.
15. "*Dungeon Crawler Carl Audiobooks*" (https://www.audible.com/series/Dungeon-Crawler-Carl-Audiobooks/B0937JMKYV). *Audible*. Retrieved November 16, 2023.
16. "*Carl's Doomsday Scenario*" (https://bookscouter.com/book/9780593820261-carl-s-doomsday-scenario-dungeon-crawler-carl). *BookScouter*. Retrieved November 16, 2023.
17. "*The Dungeon Anarchist's Cookbook*" (https://bookscouter.com/book/9780593820285-the-dungeon-anarchist-s-cookbook-dungeon-crawler-carl). *BookScouter*. Retrieved November 16, 2023.
18. "*The Gate of the Feral Gods*" (https://bookscouter.com/book/9798520410171-the-gate-of-the-feral-gods-dungeon-crawler-carl-book-4). *BookScouter*. Retrieved November 16, 2023.
19. "*The Butcher's Masquerade*" (https://bookscouter.com/book/9798418566102-the-butcher-s-masquerade-dungeon-crawler-carl-book-5). *BookScouter*. Retrieved November 16, 2023.
20. "*The Eye of the Bedlam Bride*" (https://bookscouter.com/book/9798396866379-the-eye-of-the-bedlam-bride-dungeon-crawler-carl-book-6). *BookScouter*. Retrieved November 16, 2023.
21. "*This Inevitable Ruin*" (https://bookscouter.com/book/9798344591230-this-inevitable-ruin-dungeon-crawler-carl-book-7). *BookScouter*. Retrieved November 16, 2023.
22. "Sell 9798217190065 A Parade of Horribles (Dungeon Crawler Carl)... for the best price" (https://bookscouter.com/book/9798217190065-a-parade-of-horribles-dungeon-crawler-carl?type=sell). *BookScouter.com*. Retrieved November 19, 2025.
23. "Dungeon Crawler Carl" (https://www.penguinrandomhouse.com/series/43C/dungeon-crawler-carl/). *PenguinRandomhouse.com*. Retrieved August 6, 2025.
24. Cherry, Tonya (March 5, 2023). "Dungeon Crawler Carl!" (https://www.620ckrm.com/2025/03/05/dungeon-crawler-carl/). *620 CKRM - The Voice of Saskatchewan*. Retrieved March 31, 2025.
25. "The Arthur C. Clarke Award 2026 Nominees" (https://www.clarkeaward.com/). Arthur C. Clarke Award. Retrieved June 4, 2026.
26. Maher, John (December 16, 2024). "TK: Berkley Is Having a Ball" (https://www.proquest.com/docview/3144435659). *Publishers Weekly*. **271** (48): 8. ProQuest 3144435659 (https://www.proquest.com/docview/3144435659).

action.../review/...).
27. "Audio Fiction Books - Best Sellers - Books - The New York Times" (https://www.nytimes.com/books/best-sellers/2025/03/01/audio-fiction/). *The New York Times*. March 1, 2025. ISSN 0362-4331 (https://search.worldcat.org/issn/0362-4331). Retrieved March 30, 2025.
28. "Hardcover Fiction Books - Best Sellers - Books - March 30, 2025 - The New York Times" (https://www.nytimes.com/books/best-sellers/2025/03/30/hardcover-fiction/). *The New York Times*. ISSN 0362-4331 (https://search.worldcat.org/issn/0362-4331). Retrieved April 2, 2025.
29. "Books-A-Million Announces Inaugural Book of the Year" (https://www.publishersweekly.com/pw/newsbrief/index.html?record=5622). *PublishersWeekly.com*. November 5, 2025. Retrieved January 28, 2026.
30. Schneider, Michael (June 18, 2026). "Peacock Gives Series Order to 'Dungeon Crawler Carl' TV Series From Seth MacFarlane's Fuzzy Door, Chris Yost" (https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/dungeon-crawler-carl-series-order-peacock-1236785705/). *Variety*. Retrieved June 18, 2026.
31. "Gamified novels—known as LitRPG—are a winning format" (https://www.economist.com/culture/2026/05/20/gamified-novels-known-as-litrpg-are-a-winning-format). *The Economist*. May 20, 2026. Retrieved May 30, 2026.
32. https://www.denver7.com/sports/hello-crawlers-avs-host-dungeon-crawler-carl-theme-night-to-raise-money-for-local-feline-rescue
33. Mulroy, Clare (May 9, 2026). "LitRPG is hot. Why fans can't get enough of books like 'Dungeon Crawler Carl' " (https://www.usatoday.com/story/entertainment/books/2026/05/09/best-litrpg-books-dungeon-crawler-carl/89776156007/). *USA Today*. Retrieved May 9, 2026.
34. Miller, Laura (February 7, 2026). "The Unlikely Hit That's Popularizing a Whole New Type of Novel" (https://slate.com/culture/2026/02/dungeon-crawler-carl-book-series-litrpg-audiobook-matt-dinniman.html). *Slate*. ISSN 1091-2339 (https://search.worldcat.org/issn/1091-2339). Retrieved April 25, 2026.
35. Whittock, Jesse; Goldbart, Max (August 21, 2024). "Universal International Studios Buys Matt Dinniman's 'Dungeon Crawler Carl' With Seth MacFarlane's Fuzzy Door & Chris Yost Attached" (https://deadline.com/2024/08/dungeon-crawler-carl-seth-macfarlane-universal-chris-yost-series-1236045866/). *Deadline*. Retrieved February 4, 2025.
36. Otterson, Joe; Maas, Jennifer (April 2, 2026). " 'Dungeon Crawler Carl' TV Series From Seth MacFarlane's Fuzzy Door, Chris Yost Lands at Peacock (EXCLUSIVE)" (https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/dungeon-crawler-carl-tv-series-peacock-seth-macfarlane-1236705436/). *Variety*. Retrieved June 19, 2026.
37. Lemons, Jordan (July 16, 2025). "Dungeon Crawler Carl's Long-Awaited Webtoon Debuts With Exclusive Trailer & Sneak Peek" (https://screenrant.com/dungeon-crawler-carl-webtoon-comic-first-look-trailer-exclusive/). *ScreenRant*. Retrieved August 4, 2025.
38. "Free Comic Book Day 2026: Get Your First Look at DUNGEON CRAWLER CARL and INANNA: THE NAME SHE LOST from Vault Comics" (https://blog.vaultcomics.com/free-comic-book-day-2026-get-your-first-look-at-dungeon-crawler-carl-and-inanna-the-name-she-lost-from-vault-comics/). *The Vanguardian (Vault Comics)*. February 19, 2026. Retrieved June 19, 2026.
39. "Dungeon Crawler Carl, Vol. 1—The Webtoon Edition Comes to Print for the First Time" (https://blog.vaultcomics.com/dungeon-crawler-carl-vol-1-the-webtoon-edition-comes-to-print-for-the-first-time/). *The Vanguardian*. January 13, 2026. Retrieved June 19, 2026.
40. Dinniman, Matt; Pursuit, Laurel; Tevagah (May 2026). *Dungeon Crawler Carl, Vol. 1*. Vault Comics. ISBN 9781638493655.

41. "Vault Reveals Title, Lead Character of 'Dungeon Crawler Carl' Graphic Novel" (https://icv2.com/articles/news/view/60550/vault-reveals-title-lead-character-dungeon-crawler-carl-graphic-novel). *icv2.com*. Retrieved September 25, 2025.
42. Dinniman, Matt (August 1, 2025). "Matt - Surprise, motherf*ckers! New graphic novel announcement!" (https://www.facebook.com/photo/?fbid=1310810797713806&set=a.528739465920947). *Facebook*. Retrieved August 4, 2025.
43. "Vault to Publish 'Dungeon Crawler Carl' Graphic Novel" (https://icv2.com/articles/news/view/60195/vault-publish-dungeon-crawler-carl-graphic-novel). *icv2.com*. Retrieved August 4, 2025.
44. Dohm-Sanchez, Jeffrey (July 29, 2025). "Renegade Partners with 'Dungeon Crawler Carl's' Matt Dinniman" (https://icv2.com/articles/news/view/60164/renegade-partners-dungeon-crawl-carls-matt-dinniman). *ICv2*. Retrieved August 14, 2025.
45. "Renegade Game Studios brings Matt Dinniman's Dungeon Crawler Carl to a Tabletop Near You!" (https://renegadegamestudios.com/blog/renegade-game-studios-brings-matt-dinnimans-dungeon-crawler-carl-to-a-tabletop-near-you/). *Renegade Game Studios*. July 29, 2025. Retrieved August 14, 2025.
46. https://www.ign.com/articles/the-dungeon-crawler-rpg-crowdfunding-campaign-just-launched-and-has-already-decimated-its-goals
47. https://www.polygon.com/dungeon-crawler-carl-board-game-ttrpg-backerkit/
48. https://www.polygon.com/dungeon-crawler-carl-toys-samantha/

External links

- Official website of Matt Dinniman (https://mattdinniman.com/)
- Official website of Jeff Hays (https://www.jeffhaysnarrates.com/)

Retrieved from "https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=Dungeon_Crawler_Carl&oldid=1360647996"